

a button form the input devices. Most of the recent devices have high-colour LCD display; the earlier ones were greyscale.

RIM provides a proprietary OS that's specifically coded for maximum functionality from the device. Any third party can write programs for the device using the BlackBerry APIs, but use of certain restricted functionality must be digitally signed so that it can be associated with a developer account with RIM; however, this does not guarantee the quality and security of the program.

Integration of BlackBerry with an organisation's e-mail system can be established by a support software called BlackBerry Enterprise Server (BES). It's a big advantage for organisations that have multiple wireless users. This software helps in synchronisation of these networks and also keeps employees updated with recent e-mails. BES also provides TCP/IP connectivity proxied through Mobile Data Services (MDS) to its handheld devices.

Many universities in the US and the UK have established BES integration with Microsoft Exchange Server to redirect e-mails to BlackBerry devices at the universities' campuses.

This technology is designed to suit professionals, executives and organisations that need constant Internet access through a device that is a combination of a PDA, mobile phone and laptop.

In India, only Airtel provides BlackBerry service. The integration of Blackberry with an e-mail account is done through secure GPRS connectivity.